

Chris Schulz



Team Lead | Product Manager | AI Engineer | AI Officer | Data Scientist | Data Strategist |

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Head of Data & AI with 10+ years taking AI from experiment to production in regulated FinTech and financial services. Cut after-contact work by 25%, lifted development productivity by 40%, and built AI governance ready for EU AI Act enforcement. Builds the teams alongside the systems.

Professional Experience

Dr Klein Ratenkredit GmbH

HEAD OF DATA & AI

Lübeck, Germany

May 2023 – Present

- Built the data and AI strategy around the company's business goals and rolled it into day-to-day decision-making.
- Built a production AI platform for Intelligent Document Processing (IDP) on Strands Agents SDK and Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, with model serving, a REST API layer, and CI/CD pipelines; it cut after-contact work by 25%.
- Designed a distributed datalakehouse (AWS S3, Glue, Lake Formation, Firehose, DuckDB, Iceberg) with automated quality monitoring and observability; analytics, ML training, and product data access across the company all run on it.
- Established an AI governance framework for the EU AI Act: model documentation, audit trails, explainability pipelines, and continuous bias monitoring for production decisioning systems.
- Rolled out Claude Code across the engineering team, which raised software development productivity by 40%.
- Shipped an ISMS and compliance agent (Bedrock AgentCore, Strands Agents, Claude Haiku 4.5, eu-central-1 for EU data residency). It answers information security and regulatory questions from the internal ISMS knowledge base with cited sources, using a vectorless manifest-then-fetch retrieval pattern.
- Delivered a self-service data analyst agent (AgentCore runtime, Strands Agents, CDK) that answers natural-language questions over the internal datalakehouse under existing data governance, so business stakeholders no longer queue for an analyst.
- Hired and led a 6-person AI engineering team, and set its engineering standards, sprint cadence, and delivery model; after structured technical training all 6 engineers run platform components on their own, with 80% more efficient workflows.

Amazon Bedrock AWS Claude Datalakehouse EU AI Act GenAI LLM MCP Model Governance Python Strands Agents TypeScript AI Chatbot Information Security Compliance Regulatory AI NLP LLM Applications Data Analytics Business Intelligence

Allgeier IT GmbH

CONTRACTOR DATA SCIENTIST CONSULTANT

Berlin, Germany

Dec 2022 – May 2023

- Defined the data strategy and roadmap for a client's customer service department, and matched data capabilities to their operational goals.
- Designed a cloud data management framework across the ingestion, transformation, and consumption layers, so teams across the client organization could serve themselves.

Cloud Architecture Consulting Data Strategy Python Business Intelligence

Deutsche Kreditbank AG (DKB)

LEAD DATA SCIENTIST

Berlin, Germany

Jul 2022 – Nov 2022

- Led and mentored a data science team at one of Germany's largest digital retail banks.
- Set the model development workflow, code review standards and deployment checklist for regulated production ML in banking.
- Developed the data science strategy and product roadmap for DKB's core banking AI initiatives within BaFin-regulated risk and compliance constraints.

BaFin Banking Data Science Strategy Data Science Workflow Python R Regulated ML Team Leadership Business Intelligence

Europace AG

DATA SCIENTIST | TEAM LEAD CENTRAL DATA TEAM

Berlin, Germany

Jan 2021 – Jul 2022

- Led Europace's data strategy transformation and drove adoption across every business unit.
- Extended the central data lake with modular services that gave every stakeholder group self-serve analytics.
- Built ML anomaly detection and time series forecasting pipelines that automate data validation and feed capacity planning into executive reporting.

Anomaly Detection AWS Datalake ML Python Team Leadership Time Series TypeScript Business Intelligence

DATA SCIENTIST | PRODUCT OWNER CENTRAL DATA TEAM

Jun 2020 – Jan 2021

- Designed the cloud data framework (ingestion, transformation, consumption) for the loans business.
- Built cross-team KPI dashboards that established data-driven decision-making at Europace.

AWS Datalake ETL KPI Design ML Product Deployment Python TypeScript Business Intelligence

DATA ANALYST LOANS BUSINESS

Aug 2016 – Jun 2020

- Advised partner institutions on technology and data capability across the lending ecosystem.
- Led Europace's data-drivenness initiative with partner banks and brokers.

Cerulli Associates

QUANTITATIVE ANALYST

London, UK

Oct 2015 – Aug 2016

- Ran market sizing and forecasts across European markets and asset classes, and calibrated the underlying models.
- Sourced, validated, and analyzed data to produce client insights.
- Researched distribution trends in institutional asset management; clients used the findings to calibrate market penetration strategies.

Campaign Management Financial Markets Forecasting Institutional Asset Management Quantitative Analysis Business Intelligence

Lloyds Banking Group

BUSINESS ANALYST

Berlin, Germany

Mar 2014 – Oct 2015

- Created a selection algorithm weighing customer preferences against qualitative and quantitative ETF characteristics to generate tailored investment advice.
- Designed the asset allocation framework for an investment product targeting mass affluent clients.

Asset Allocation Deposit Insurance ETF Financial Services Investment Project Management Retail Banking Business Intelligence

Alstom Power

PROJECT MANAGEMENT TRAINEE

Zurich, Switzerland

Dec 2013 – Mar 2014

- Controlled the budgets of 4 EMEA power plant projects from construction to commissioning, and held all 4 to plan.
- Produced and presented financial forecasts, construction reviews, cost calculations, and database updates for project stakeholders.

Budgeting Controlling Financial Forecasting Project Management

Education

Leipzig University

MSC MANAGEMENT SCIENCE

Leipzig, GER / London, UK

Oct 2011 – Oct 2013

- Key areas: finance, accounting and taxation
- Dissertation: Portfolio Management and Overlay Strategies in Practice
- Semester abroad within Erasmus exchange program (University of East London)

Leipzig University

BSC ECONOMICS & MANAGEMENT SCIENCE

Leipzig, GER

Oct 2008 – Oct 2011

- Key areas: accounting, finance, macroeconomics
- Dissertation: Information Content of Lagged Equity and Bond Yields

Skills

Generative AI & LLMs

GenAI Patterns (RAG, Agents, Chain-of-Thought, ReAct, DSPy) | LLM Frameworks (Agno, CrewAI, HuggingFace, LangChain, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, Strands Agents) | Models & APIs (Anthropic, Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, HuggingFace, Ollama) | LLM Ops (Deployment, Monitoring) | Fine-tuning (PEFT, LoRA, QLoRA, RLHF, DPO, Unsloth) | Vector Databases (Amazon S3 Vectors, ChromaDB, FalkorDB, Qdrant) | Model Context Protocol (MCP Server Implementation, Client Integration)

ML & Data Science

Languages (Python, R, SQL, TypeScript) | Classical ML (Regression, Classification, Clustering, XGBoost, LightGBM, Scikit-learn) | Deep Learning (Neural Networks, Transformers) | Time Series (Forecasting, Classification, Anomaly Detection, Nixtla) | Data Visualization (Plotly, Streamlit, Shiny)

Platform & Data Eng.

Platform Engineering (Model Serving, API Design, Pipeline Orchestration, Standardized Deployment) | AWS (S3, Glue, Athena, DynamoDB, Firehose, ECS, Lambda, EventBridge, SageMaker) | Data Processing (Arrow, DuckDB, Apache Iceberg, Apache Spark, Pandas, Polars) | Databases (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Redshift) | DevOps & Tools (Docker, Git, CI/CD via GitHub Actions, AWS CDK, Claude Code)

Leadership & Strategy

Team Building (AI Engineers, Data Engineers, ML Engineers, Hiring, Mentoring, Agile/Scrum) | Operating Model (Delivery Excellence, Engineering Standards, Cross-market Rollout) | Strategy (AI Roadmap, Data Strategy, Platform Vision, Stakeholder Management)

Regulation

Regulation & Compliance (Data Protection, Data Privacy, Data Governance, Model Governance) | EU AI Act Compliance | Model Governance & Auditability | GDPR-Compliant ML Pipelines | Explainable AI (XAI) | Continuous Bias Monitoring | Data Quality Evaluation